

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	750
		Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	01/2017
		Review Date:	07/2028

SPINAL MOTION RESTRICTION (SMR)		
ADULT	PEDIATRIC	
BLS		
PEARLS - A rigid cervical collar should not be placed or shall be removed if: - The collar creates an airway compromise - The appropriate sized collar is unavailable - The collar increases pain - The patient's anatomy precludes fitting a collar (i.e. severe curvature of the spine) - The patient is combative & fighting the application of the collar - Patients already immobilized should remain immobilized - Patients with penetrating injuries do not require SMR unless they meet specific criteria in the algorithm - Long Spine Boards should be avoided in ambulatory patients - Elderly or kyphotic individuals requiring SMR may require vacuum immobilization devices - SMR does not take precedence over airway or cardiovascular stabilization - Leave helmets and shoulder pads in place unless they interfere with resuscitation - Ambulatory patients and those that can self- extricate, are cooperative, can follow instructions and who have only midline cervical or thoracic pain may be placed in a rigid collar and secured to the ambulance gurney (No Long Spine Board Necessary)	Mechanism of injury compatible with possible spinal injury → No → Yes Spinal deformity on exam → Yes → No Patient is ≤ 7 years or “elderly” as age extremes are prone to unreliable history. (Consider SMR if there are any concerns) → Yes → No Penetrating injury with gross motor or sensory deficits → Yes → No Altered level of consciousness → Yes → No Intoxicated (drugs and/or alcohol) with impairment or lack of capacity → Yes → No Gross motor or sensory deficits such as numbness or tingling. Assess CMS. → Yes → No Cervical, thoracic lumbar, midline, or paraspinal pain or tenderness → Yes → No Language barrier preventing a reliable exam (Consider SMR if there are any concerns) → Yes → No Distracting pain. (Fixating on one location of pain) → Yes → No THE PATIENT DOES NOT REQUIRE SMR	NO SMR APPLY SPINAL MOTION RESTRICTION

Signatures on File

Approved By: Tim Williams
EMS Administrator

Ajinder Singh, MD
EMS Medical Director